

Chapter 37 - Love and Illness

Feng Yue's blogging career was gradually getting on track. After releasing her first video, her followers had slowly broken through the thirty thousand mark.

Moreover, the data response for the subsequent videos she released was also quite good, and comments in the comment section discussing the videos themselves had increased.

On this day, Feng Yue prepared to go out to buy ingredients according to her plan, then return home to start filming material for her next video.

After filming this material, she would also start her vacation. She had already made plans with Zhou Qiongqiong, Wen Zhen and the others to go to a resort villa near Beijing for two days during Golden Week¹ next week.

As soon as Feng Yue stepped out of the elevator, she saw a familiar person.

"Miss Feng, long time no see!"

Feng Yue saw the other person and a flash of surprise crossed her eyes. It was her neighbor who lived downstairs, surnamed Li.

"Miss Li, long time no see. Are you also heading out?"

When Feng Yue first moved to Songhe Bay, she had first met this Miss Li in the elevator. At that time, she had to carry packages and also handle other things, and not watching where she was going, she accidentally bumped into her.

Miss Li not only didn't blame her, but also helped her carry two delivery bags.

This was how the two got acquainted, and they later exchanged contact information. Occasionally, when Miss Li cooked something, she would bring some to Feng Yue.

However, after Feng Yue got married and moved to the villa, she had pretty much lost contact with her.

When she moved back to Songhe Bay this time, she hadn't thought to contact her either.

Miss Li herself was very friendly and talkative. Since both were going to the parking garage to get their cars, they chatted briefly.

Only then did Feng Yue learn that Miss Li was returning today to handle property procedures. She hadn't lived here for a long time either, so she had recently sold this apartment.

"Ah, we two really have bad timing. You moved back, and I'm moving away." Miss Li quite liked this young lady—she was beautiful and had a gentle personality.

Feng Yue also felt somewhat regretful: "It is quite a pity, but we can still get together again if there's a chance in the future."

"That's true. It's very convenient to arrange dinner with someone nowadays."

"Yes." Feng Yue said, "But why did you decide to sell the apartment? I think renting it out would be better."

Miss Li shook her head: "Anyone who can afford to rent an apartment in Songhe Bay might as well buy one instead. Besides, I've always lived in this apartment alone, so I'd be reluctant to rent it out. However, I sold this apartment for much higher than market price. The buyer seemed quite eager to purchase it, though I don't know why."

"I heard the buyer also lives alone."

"Heard?"

Miss Li nodded: "The person who bought my apartment never appeared in person. All the procedures were handled by an assistant or secretary. According to the secretary, the buyer has been very busy recently and had no time. But apparently they plan to move in directly today."

"Then they probably work nearby. Among the nearby developments, only Songhe Bay has a better environment."

"That's true."

As they spoke, the two arrived at the parking garage. After exchanging a few more pleasantries, they waved goodbye to each other.

Feng Yue didn't take this matter to heart, so after driving to the supermarket, she completely immersed herself in the joy of shopping.

Feng Yue really enjoyed shopping at supermarkets. Whether buying a lot or a little, she liked the feeling of carefully selecting each item she needed with her own hands.

This would give her a satisfying sense of security from deep within.

This supermarket was quite large, with four floors total, selling everything. However, Feng Yue only planned to buy ingredients today, so she took the elevator to the second floor.

Feng Yue pushed her shopping cart alone, starting to select items methodically from the entrance.

She spent about half an hour shopping before buying all the ingredients she needed.

Feng Yue pushed her shopping cart to the checkout counter. The cashier had scanned about half the items when Feng Yue heard a familiar female voice behind her.

"Xiao Yue?"

Feng Yue turned around, and sure enough, standing behind her pushing a shopping cart was none other than Yan Lin's mother.

The last time Feng Yue had seen Yan Lin's parents was when she had forced Yan Lin to break off their engagement at Wen Zhen's shop.

She hadn't expected that just going out to shop at a supermarket today, she would encounter her ex-wife's mother.

Feng Yue herself had no complaints about Yan Lin's mother. In fact, she respected Yan Lin's parents more than she resented them.

Even though she and Yan Lin had long since had nothing to do with each other, she couldn't just ignore Yan Lin's mother here.

"...Auntie." After calling her "Mom" for over a year, calling her "Auntie" now felt quite unnatural.

Yan Lin's mother was surprised to see her, but also happy, responding with a smile: "I thought that back looked like you, and I was right."

"I haven't seen you for a long time either. How has your health been recently? Is the treatment going smoothly?" The concern in Yan Lin's mother's eyes was pure, without any other emotions mixed in.

Feng Yue couldn't speak harshly to an elder, so she could only nod obediently: "I'm fine, and the treatment is going very smoothly."

"That's good." Yan Lin's mother nodded. Looking at Feng Yue, she couldn't help but talk more.

"Why are you shopping at the supermarket here? This should be quite far from where your mother and them live, right?"

Feng Yue nodded: "I'm not living with my mom and them. I'm living alone here now."

A flash of surprise crossed Yan Lin's mother's eyes. She had thought that given Feng Yue's mother's personality, she would keep her child by her side, especially since Feng Yue was currently ill. There was also the fact that she suddenly understood why her stubborn daughter had suddenly bought a second-hand apartment in this area and was even eager to move in as soon as possible.

Yan Lin's mother calmly patted Feng Yue's shoulder: "Are you used to living alone usually?"

"It's alright. My mom comes to check on me from time to time. Living alone is quite peaceful."

"That's good, that's good."

The two chatted about other things. Throughout the conversation, Yan Lin's mother never mentioned Yan Lin's name once, just caring about Feng Yue's daily life like an ordinary elder.

Later, Yan Lin's mother received a phone call saying she had something urgent to attend to, so Feng Yue left first with her shopping bags.

Yan Lin's mother watched Feng Yue's departing figure, quickly finished her phone call in a few words, and her expression became somewhat serious.

Her concern for Feng Yue wasn't fake, and she also knew that Yan Lin must have done something back then for Feng Yue to choose divorce.

So, between her daughter's feelings on one side and Feng Yue's health as her former daughter-in-law on the other, she would choose the latter without hesitation.

Yan Lin's mother stood in place for quite a while before finally calling Yan Lin.

Yan Lin's voice answered: "Mom?"

"Tell me honestly, did you buy that new apartment because of Xiao Yue?" Yan Lin's mother's voice was very serious.

Yan Lin knew her mother was going to buy household items for her new home today, but she hadn't expected her mother to discover this matter so quickly.

"What happened?" Yan Lin asked, trying to change the subject.

"Don't try to change the subject with me. Just answer whether it is or not."

There was a long silence on Yan Lin's end, then Yan Lin's mother finally heard her muffled acknowledgment.

"Yan Lin, do you know that Xiao Yue is still sick!" Yan Lin's mother carried her shopping bags and walked angrily toward the parking garage. "What exactly are you trying to do now? Are you completely disregarding her condition?"

Yan Lin's grip on her phone tightened, then slowly loosened: "I know, and I'm not disregarding her health either. I won't deliberately appear in front of her. I just..."

"...want to be closer to her."

"You're simply being ridiculous! You were there when we listened to Dr. Wei explain Xiao Yue's condition. How can you not consider others at all!"

"I tried to avoid her completely." Yan Lin silently closed her eyes, and the image of Feng Yue and Wen Zhen leaving together at the restaurant appeared in her mind again. "But I can't accept her being with someone else. Just thinking about her falling in love and getting married with someone else makes me feel like I can't breathe."

Yan Lin clearly understood that this was the shackle Feng Yue had placed around her neck. Every step Feng Yue moved away from her, the shackle around her neck would tighten a bit more. Until Feng Yue finally completely disappeared from her world, then the air in her world would be completely cut off.

"But you still can't just—" Yan Lin's mother hadn't had time to scold her further and stop her when Yan Lin interrupted her.

"Mom, I know my limits. There are still things at the company, so I'll hang up first." After saying this, Yan Lin hung up the phone without caring about her mother's reaction.

Yan Lin's mother heard the "beep" sound of the phone being hung up and was simply furious. She gritted her teeth: "This damn girl!"

After hanging up the phone, Yan Lin completely deflated.

She lowered her head, hands supporting both temples, her eyes somewhat red. Whether it was from staying up late working or from the dull pain coming from her heart, it was unclear.

Yan Lin took a moment to recover, then straightened up and picked up a photo frame placed on the left side of her desk.

Inside was one of the few photos of her and Feng Yue together. In the photo, Feng Yue appeared carefree and proud. And herself standing next to Feng Yue looked no different from what she usually saw in the mirror.

Yan Lin had grown up hearing praise from others, so she had never thought she was particularly beautiful.

Rather, it was Feng Yue standing beside her in the photo—with her soft and gentle eyebrows, crimson lips and white teeth, fair and delicate skin—this Feng Yue composed of these features was what she recognized as beautiful and lovely.

But her previous self had been like someone blind and deaf, unable to see or hear, forcefully isolating Feng Yue with an impenetrable wall of ice, even hurting her.

Yan Lin knew that if she really wanted what was best for Feng Yue, she should completely disappear from Feng Yue's world.

But she couldn't do it. Call her selfish, call her shameless.

She just wanted to get closer to Feng Yue, wanted to rebuild a new home with Feng Yue, wanted to live with Feng Yue like an ordinary married couple.

She had originally had this chance, but she had personally destroyed it.

Yan Lin's thoughts drifted away until a phone call pulled her back. She looked at the caller ID—it was her father.

"Hello, Dad."

"Your mother called me. Come home tonight."

Yan Lin knew this was unavoidable, so she responded flatly: "I understand."

Footnotes:

¹ Golden Week (黄金周) - A week-long holiday period in China, typically referring to the National Day holiday (October 1-7) or Chinese New Year holiday.